

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 8 5  
♥ J 10 6 5 3 2  
♦ Q J 9  
♣ A

♠ K 9 2  
♥ A K 8 7 4  
♦ K 10 7  
♣ 10 8



♠ A 7 4 3  
♥ Q  
♦ A 6 4 2  
♣ 7 6 4 3

♠ J 10 6  
♥ 9  
♦ 8 5 3  
♣ K Q J 9 5 2

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♥

Dbl

2 ♣<sup>1</sup>

All Pass

1. 6+ ♣s, fewer than 10 points

North opens 1 ♥ and East Doubles.

After the intervening Takeout Double **2/1 is OFF**. If you had 10 or more points you would Redouble. So even with only 9 points you can bid 2 ♣ without fear that North will think you have a strong hand. North also knows everything mentioned above so he passes.

**Board 3**

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A K 9 8 7 6 4  
 ♥ K Q 7  
 ♦ K 7 3  
 ♣ -

♠ 10 3

♥ 9 8 4

♦ A 9

♣ Q 8 7 6 3 2

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ Q J 2

♥ J 2

♦ Q J 8 6 2

♣ A K J

♠ 5

♥ A 10 6 5 3

♦ 10 5 4

♣ 10 9 5 4

| West | North | East | South |
|------|-------|------|-------|
| 1 ♠  | Pass  | 2 ♦  | Pass  |
| 2 ♠  | Pass  | 3 ♠  | Pass  |
| 4 ♣  | Pass  | 4 ♠  |       |

All Pass

would have shown one Ace and West wouldn't know what to do next. She might have figured the odds favored that one Ace being a red one and tried the slam. Moral: Don't use Blackwood when you have a void.

You have a great hand - how will you start the bidding? You open 1 ♠. East responds 2 ♦, a 2/1 force to game. You have a big hand, perhaps in the slam range, but first priority is to set a trump suit. So you contend yourself with a rebid of 2 ♠. East agrees on trumps by bidding 3 ♠ (not Fast Arrival). What do you do now? Now you make your slam try by using a Control-showing cue-bid. She bids 4 ♣, showing first or second round control of the suit (Ace or king, or singleton or void). East bids 4 ♠. What do you do now?

East's next bid would be a control-showing bid of her own - IF SHE HAD ONE. Since she cannot win the first or second round of either red suit she just returns to 4 ♠. West realizes that they are off two red Aces and passes. Notice that West did not fall into the Blackwood trap. If you HAD asked for Aces, East